SARA SANTANDER

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PROFILE

Economist and MSc student at the University of Geneva (econometrics track), with applied research experience in development economics, causal inference and trade. I aim to pursue a PhD in economics. My work is rooted in the belief that everyone deserves a fair chance to live a dignified life.

EDUCATION

MSc in Economics, *University of Geneva (UNIGE)*
Sep 2024 – Nov 2026
Geneva, Switzerland
GPA: 5.75/6. Track of specialization in econometrics.
Thesis: "Does HPV Vaccine Eligibility Change Adolescent Behaviour? Evidence from Bolivia's 2017 Rollout" (regression discontinuity design, DHS 2023).

BSc in Economics, *Universidad Privada Boliviana (UPB)*
Feb 2017 – Dec 2021
La Paz, Bolivia
GPA: 96.56/100. Minor in Development Economics.
Thesis: "The setback in the reduction of multidimensional poverty in Bolivia caused by an increase in school absenteeism due to the COVID-19 pandemic"

PUBLICATIONS

Published Papers

- Morales, J., & Santander, S. (2025). Assessing Cigarette Reduction Tax-Effectiveness in Low Tobacco Expenditure Contexts: An Application to Bolivia. *Health Economics*. https://doi.org/10.1002/hec.4931

Working Papers

- Santander, S., & Nogales, R. (2022). Leaving the Most Vulnerable Behind? School Closures During the COVID-19 Pandemic and Pre-Existing Life Struggles in Bolivia. *Undergraduate Research Competition, Central Bank of Bolivia — 2nd Place*

Book Chapters

- Olarreaga, M., & Santander, S. (2025). "Who Pays for US Tariffs?" In G. Gensler, S. Johnson, U. Panizza, & B. Weder di Mauro (Eds.), *The Economic Consequences of the Second Trump Administration: A Preliminary Assessment*. CEPR Press, Paris & London. *CEPR eBook page (link)*

Acknowledged Contributions

- Urquidi, M., Ergueta, A., Durand, G., Sardán, S., & Serrate, L. (2023). Labor Market Analysis: Characteristics of Firms, Workforce, and Skills in Bolivian Cities in 2022. https://doi.org/10.18235/0005379
- Román, S., & Córdova, P. (2022). Social Inequality in Health: Non-Communicable Diseases in Bolivia, Determinants, and Current Challenges at the Municipal Level. https://doi.org/10.21203/rs.3.rs-1459545/v1
- Eguino, H., Román, S., Schächtele, S., & Canavire-Bacarreza, G. (2021). Behavioral Economics and Municipal Tax Administration: Recent Applications in Latin America. https://doi.org/10.18235/0003729

EXPERIENCE

Intern
Feb 2026 - Aug 2026
World Trade Organization (WTO) - Trade Policies Review Division
Geneva, Switzerland

- Built and maintain R-based pipelines that turn 10+ years of bilateral HS/MTN trade data into indicators (RCA, Grubel-Lloyd, HHP, LFI) feeding country dashboards for WTO Trade Policy Reviews.
- Designed API-based Python pipelines (FRED, BEA, USITC) to automate data collection for macro and trade analysis, improving both speed and reproducibility.
- Led quantitative analysis of U.S. agricultural and manufacturing trade shifts, identifying a structural reversal in the agricultural trade balance and tracing it to asymmetric import/export growth. These findings informed the ongoing U.S. Trade Policy Review.

Project Manager
Apr 2024 - Aug 2024
Parstats
Montevideo, Uruguay

- Designed data-collection strategies and survey instruments for an IDB-funded impact evaluation of rural infrastructure investment in Guyana, tailoring tools to household- and community-level indicators.
- Oversaw cleaning, validation, and QA of household and village-level microdata (1,000+ households, 100 communities), producing analysis-ready datasets through reproducible Stata pipelines.
- Coordinated village-level focus groups to capture community perceptions of service delivery and implementation feedback, feeding qualitative insight into the program's evaluation.

Research Assistant Apr 2022 - Mar 2024
Research Centre in Economics and Entrepreneurship (CIEE – UPB) *La Paz, Bolivia*

- Directed an IDB-funded study on disability and labor exclusion. Led a nationwide survey (300+ respondents) on labor market barriers for people with disabilities in Bolivia, directing field teams, building a PCA-based index, and delivering an evidence report with reproducible Stata scripts for policy use.
- Managed a systematic review of 400+ academic studies on employment-access programs for an IDB meta-analysis, establishing extraction standards and codebooks to ensure data traceability and informing labor policy recommendations.
- Co-authored a peer-reviewed paper (Health Economics, 2025) modeling cigarette demand elasticities using Deaton's spatial price adjustment and a Heckman selection model, with simulations of tax-policy impacts.

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Simon I. Patiño 2024-2026 fully funded scholarship for a graduate program (2024) based on my academic performance.
- Second Place in the Research Competition (Undergraduate Category) at the 15th Meeting of Economists organized by the Central Bank of Bolivia (BCB) (2022).
- Speaker at the Bolivian Conference on Development Economics (BCDE) in 2022 and 2023.
- First Place in the 4th Course of Excellence in Economics at *Universidad de Chile*, earning a full scholarship for a graduate program (2021).
- Fully-funded scholarship recipient from the "Emerging Leaders in the Americas Program (ELAP)" through the Embassy of Canada for an academic exchange program (2019) based on my academic performance.

SKILLS

Quantitative Analysis & Data	Econometrics, Causal inference, Impact evaluation, Survey methods, Statistical analysis, Data cleaning, QA/QC, Reproducible research, API integration, Data visualization
Programming & Automation	Stata, R, Python, Git.
Languages	Spanish (native), English (C1, TOEFL 105), French (A2).
Collaboration	Cross-cultural teamwork, Multilateral coordination, stakeholder communication, project management

REFERENCES AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST